MEASURED UNIT ECONOMICS

Promise Ledger

Contract verification that turns signed clauses into repeatable system checks, traceable evidence, and reviewable remediation.

MEASURED AUDIT COST	BASE GROSS MARGIN	BREAK-EVEN
$0.016505	**75.84%**	**~386 contracts**

The wedge	The business
Existing contract tools extract obligations. Promise Ledger goes further: it tests each signed promise against code, data, and infrastructure, and preserves the evidence behind every verdict.	Start with security and legal teams managing high-value B2B contracts. Sell monitoring as a platform subscription, with contract count as the expansion metric.

Prepared for neatHack 2026 by team el el ems

EVIDENCE BEFORE ASSUMPTIONS

One audit, measured

The baseline is a saved live run over three documents and nine canonical promises. Provider usage was captured with the audit result, so token volume is measured rather than estimated.

Documents	Promises	Model calls	Prompt tokens	Completion tokens
3	9	3	2,886	929

Cost equation

(2,886 / 1M x $2.50) + (929 / 1M x $10.00) = $0.016505 per audit

What actually drives margin

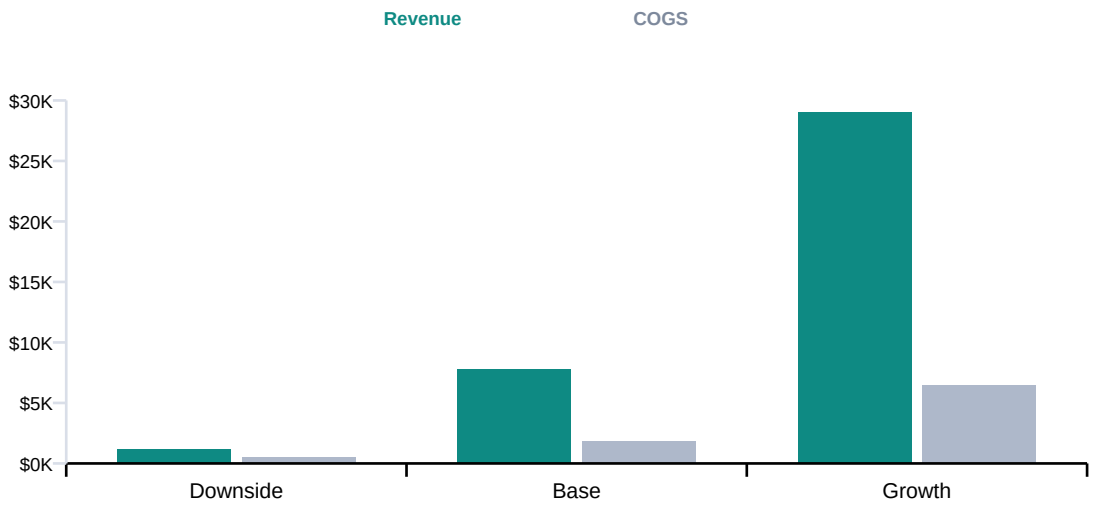
Model tokens are not the constraint. At the base volume, model API expense is only $26.41 per month. Infrastructure, review support, security work, and customer operations dominate COGS. The pricing experiment should therefore validate willingness to pay and support intensity, not optimize pennies of inference first.

Pricing hypothesis

PER CONTRACT	PLATFORM - RECOMMENDED
$49 per monitored contract per month, including six scheduled or change-triggered audits.	$499 per month including 20 contracts, then $19 for each additional contract.

THREE OPERATING CASES

Scale changes the economics



Scenario	Contracts	Revenue	COGS	Gross margin	Net cash flow	Runway
Downside	25	$1,225	$503	58.92%	-$4,278	11.69 mo
Base	200	$7,800	$1,884	75.84%	-$6,084	8.22 mo
Growth	1,000	$29,000	$6,515	77.53%	$485	Positive

Base case

At 200 contracts, monthly revenue reaches $7,800 at a 75.84% gross margin. The company deliberately remains in investment mode with -$6,084 monthly net cash flow and 8.22 months of runway on $50,000 opening cash.

Break-even

Base-case contribution is approximately $32.83 per monitored contract per month after variable model, observability, and per-contract support. With about $12,650 of fixed monthly infrastructure and operating expense, break-even is approximately 386 monitored contracts.

WHAT TO LEARN NEXT

A finance plan for discovery

The model is a decision tool, not a forecast promise. Each assumption has a corresponding customer or operational experiment.

Assumption	Experiment	Decision signal
Legal and security teams will pay for continuous clause verification.	Run 10 design-partner demos using one signed DPA and one live codebase.	At least 3 teams agree to a paid pilot at $499/month.
Support load stays below $6 per contract per month at scale.	Track reviewer minutes, escalations, and unverifiable promises for every pilot.	Median human review remains under 10 minutes per changed contract.
A platform plan sells better than per-contract pricing.	Quote both packages in alternating discovery calls.	Platform offer wins without materially lowering annual contract value.
Audit quality holds as contract volume grows.	Expand the seeded benchmark and review every false hold.	No false holds in the release gate; unverifiable stays explicit.

Accounting boundary

Measured inputs: token usage, documents, promises, and model calls from the saved live audit. Assumed inputs: provider prices, infrastructure, support, payroll, and sales pace. Replace assumed values with cfo.ai actuals and invoices before fundraising, hiring, or pricing decisions.

Recommended next move: recruit three paid design partners before optimizing inference cost.

Source: evidence/cfo_inputs.csv and evidence/run_live_audit.json. Prepared October 11, 2026.